John French - Product/Design Director hello@johnfrench.xyz

John French is a Product Design, UX, and Delivery leader with over fifteen years of industry experience, including time **leading large organizations of Designers, Researchers, Product Managers, Content Designers, Engineers, and Accessibility Specialists** as well as leading delivery efforts on web applications, digital services, and APIs on a variety of cross-functional teams. Most recently, he has **led the delivery and growth efforts for the Department of Veteran Affairs** Business Unit at Ad Hoc LLC and helped found the **State and Local Delivery Rapid Response Digital Service** team for MO Studios.

John has worked with teams across the public and private sectors, helping apply to Human-Centered Design best-practices on contracts with the VA, Library of Congress, the U.S. Office of Personnel Management, Social Security Administration, Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services, and more. John also has helped support, design, and implement recruitment, growth, and business development improvements to drive growth and attract top talent.

John was previously the UX Design Lead for the Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services' (CMS) PACA/DC Geo and Blue Button 2.0 API platforms, leading efforts to utilize Medicare claims data to help improve healthcare outcomes for people with Medicare, while reducing costs for providers and Accountable Care Organizations and improving outcomes for insurers.

His professional experience is rooted in web development, giving him the ability to work seamlessly with developers and engineers on complex technological challenges, as well as with non-technical peers and end-users. As a member of industry-leading interoperability efforts, John helped solidify API best practices with the CMS Human-Centered Design and API community initiatives, and helped start Ad Hoc's API Community of Practice. John brings the ideals and best-in-practice methodologies of service design to government services, APIs, and teams.

Experience

MO Studios: Digital Services Lead (State and Local Portfolio), September 2025 - Present ●
Helped found, staff, and develop the new State and Local Digital Service Portfolio for MO Studios. ● Helped draft and procure contracts with the commonwealth of Pennsylvania for rapid H.R. 1 digital response work to comply with MA Work Requirements - working to keep as many individuals covered as possible.

● Lead Product, Design, and Delivery efforts (as well as contractual delivery compliance). ● Coordinated delivery efforts across multiple teams and vendors, reporting directly to the CIO and Deputy Secretary.

● Run all product, requirement definition, and agile ceremonies for the initial rapid response team. ● Developed, led, and facilitated on-the-ground workshop for requirements definition with high-level Pennsylvania leadership task force.

Ad Hoc: Experience Director (VA & Federal Civilian Portfolio), January 2022 - Present ●
Oversee eight distinct cross-functional delivery teams and Design Managers, supporting a total of 54 Designers, Researchers, Content Designers, Technical Writers, and Accessibility Specialists. ● In addition to delivery quality support, provide 1:1 support as well as group mentorship, culture, and training initiatives to help direct reports level up their Design, Communication, and Stakeholder Engagement skills.

● Coordinate and support cross-functional product and delivery efforts, including discovery sprints and generative research as well as design system management and low and high fidelity prototyping, content design, and accessibility delivery efforts

● Helps hire, train, mentor, manage and provide overall guidance and individual career direction to assigned teams, as well as performance reviews.

● Assisted with the overhaul of Ad Hoc LLC's recruiting, interview, and hiring process to increase time-to-hire without impacting retention or delivery quality, saving roughly four hours of overhead

time per job posting.
- Helping to define and mature various capabilities across the company, including Experience Design and Observability/DevOps
- Drafting assessment tooling to be able to measure the maturity of various capabilities and introduce improvements

Ad Hoc: Managing Principal Designer, August 2021 – January 2022

- Manages various teams of designers and leads strategic design initiatives across a portfolio of products and programs.
- Helps hire, mentor, manage and provide overall guidance and individual career direction to assigned teams.
- Assists in the growth and strategies of the overall design practice at Ad Hoc. ● Completed successful website redesign for the State of Louisiana as well as provided strategic DesignOps recommendations to the U.S. Office of Personnel Management.

Ad Hoc: Senior 2 UX Designer & Front-end Specialist (CMS DC Geo API), December 2020 - August 2021

- Facilitated initial research by running discovery sprints and user interviews to quickly test and iterate on the team's initial problem statement with potential user feedback; drafted a whitepaper with CMS to make recommendations to the Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Innovation office.
- Helped establish research and HCD best-practices in coordination with existing APIs in the CMS' Data and Analytics Strategy Group (DASG).
- Helped assist in FHIR resource selection and data planning for initial MVP solution. ● Worked to implement API service as a new endpoint in the pre-existing Beneficiary Claims Data API, coordinated across teams to develop onboarding resources, documentation, and resources.

Ad Hoc: Senior UX Designer & Front-end Specialist (CMS Blue Button 2.0 API), August 2018 - December 2020

- In support of CMS, Lead UX Design Specialist; established and led development of HCD practices for the Blue Button 2.0 API, conducting extensive research with third-party developers, partner organizations, and Medicare Beneficiaries.
- Improved developer onboarding pipeline, resources, documentation, and sandbox account interface, allowing developers to get up and running with the API as quickly as possible. ● Designed, researched, and implemented OAuth "scopes," which gave Medicare beneficiaries the ability to choose which data they share with third parties for the first time.
- Conducted extensive privacy and usability research to understand how Medicare beneficiaries are and are not protected by privacy policies; helped draft updates to the Blue Button 2.0 APIs Terms of Service and developed automated oversight mechanisms.

University of Georgia (UGA), College of Agricultural & Environmental Sciences: Lead UX Designer/Web Developer, 2015–2018

- Accomplished a comprehensive redesign of four major site networks of 10,000+ pages. ● Increased overall faculty productivity by implementing an improved content management system and increased user responsiveness and satisfaction through thoughtful UI/UX design and use of modern best practices for development.
- Designs won multiple awards from the Association for Communication Excellence.

University of Georgia (UGA) and Coca Cola Foundation: UX Designer/Web Developer, 2014–2015

- Achieved a 50% increase in total users through a comprehensive platform redesign, securing additional funding for the fitness tracking web app and wellness platform.
- Responsible for all front-end design and development; collaborated with the team to define

platform architecture and underlying logic working closely with the backend engineering team.

The Seed & Plate: UX Designer/Web Developer, 2013–2014

- As a founding member of the publication, responsible for the initial design direction of the web platform.
- Designed and implemented a comprehensive brand identity through UI, print, and graphic design. ● Responsible for all maintenance and updates to the web platform as the publication scaled.

Freelance: Web Developer/Designer, 2010–2013

- Developed brand identity and web presence for a myriad of small businesses and individuals. ● Developed against various web Content Management Systems and made strategic stack decisions based on the needs of each client.
- Self-directed, self-motivated, and highly productive and engaged in client/stakeholder relations

Education: Bachelor of Arts - English, University of Georgia

Tools & Skills:

UX & UI Design

- End-to-end product design (discovery through delivery)
- Interaction design and microinteractions
- Visual and interface design for mobile and web (iOS, Android, responsive web)
- Design systems development and maintenance
- Prototyping and design iteration

Research & Data-Driven Design

- User research (interviews, surveys, diary studies)
- Usability testing and iteration
- Metric-based decision-making (conversion, retention, engagement)
- A/B testing and experimentation
- Heuristic evaluation and user flows

Product & Communication

- Requirements definition, product management, roadmapping, prioritization frameworks
- Cross-functional collaboration with PM, Engineering, Marketing, and Data teams ● Agile and lean product development methodologies
- Design critiques and team feedback sessions
- Clear storytelling and rationale for design decisions

Inclusive & Scalable Design

- Accessibility (WCAG compliance, screen readers, color contrast)
- Internationalization/localization
- Mobile-first and responsive design
- Growth design strategies (activation, retention, monetization)

AI & Emerging Tech

- Prompt engineering and creative use of generative AI tools
- AI-integrated workflows for design exploration and ideation
- Evaluation of AI outputs in creative and practical contexts

Other

- Strong product sensibility and customer-first mindset
- Experience working in both startup and established environments
- Growth mindset with a love for experimentation and iteration